



WHAT YOU VALUE MOST

What an unhurried dental visit looks like

Why appointment length is most of what you are paying for, six questions that reveal how a practice actually runs its day, and what a good appointment feels like from the chair.

The Unhurried · A Dentist Fit guide · General information, not dental advice

Why this is a reasonable thing to want

Time in a dental appointment is not comfort padding. It is when the checking happens. The difference between a thorough examination and a quick one is largely minutes, and so is the difference between a question answered properly and a question deflected.

It is also when the incidental finding happens. Plenty of the most useful things a dentist notices were not the reason you booked, and noticing them requires looking for a while at something nobody flagged.

None of this makes a shorter appointment wrong. Efficiency is a legitimate thing to run a practice on and plenty of people prefer it. It does mean that if you want the unhurried version, it is worth checking that it exists before you rely on it.

Six questions worth asking any practice

These work on any practice. Take them with you wherever you go, including somewhere that is not us.

1 How long is a new patient examination booked for?

Ask for the number in minutes. It is the single most informative thing you can learn about a practice in one question.

2 How long is a routine checkup and cleaning?

The recall appointment is the one you will have most often, so its length matters more over ten years than the first visit does.

3 How many patients does the dentist see in a day?

This and the previous answer should be consistent with each other. If they are not, ask about it.

4 Does the dentist do the examination, and how long are they in the room?

A long appointment is not the same as a long appointment with the dentist. Both are fine, but they are different things.

5 What happens if you find something mid-appointment?

The revealing part is whether they stop and explain, or add it to a plan and keep moving. Both happen. You are entitled to know which.

6 Can I see what you are seeing?

Intraoral cameras and screen-shared x-rays are common. A practice that shows you the picture is a practice budgeting time to explain it.

The waiting room is not the signal. A short wait can mean a well run schedule or a fast conveyor. A long wait can mean chaos or a dentist who refuses to cut someone short. Ask about appointment length instead, because that number cannot be spun.

Signs you are actually getting it

- You could explain to someone else what was found and why it matters
- You were asked questions rather than only told things
- Nothing started before you knew what it was
- You never felt the next patient waiting behind you
- There was room for the question you almost did not ask

WHERE WE FIT

A small practice, on purpose

Reflections is two chairs on Crowchild Trail. Dr. Ashish Mehta sees a small number of people, and that is a deliberate choice about how he wants to practise.

Appointments here run longer because two chairs makes that possible. The visit where you come back and say something still does not feel right is a normal part of the process rather than a favour being done for you.

"I see a small number of people, and that is on purpose."

Dr. Ashish Mehta

Ask us these too

This guide is only worth anything if it works on us as well. If you come in, put these to Dr. Mehta directly.

1 How long do you book my appointments for?

Ask for the actual number, then compare it with anywhere else you are considering.

2 How many people will you see the day I come in?

It is a fair question and the answer is easy to give if the number is reasonable.

3

What happens if my appointment needs more time than booked?

The answer tells you whether the schedule serves the dentistry or the other way round.

Fifteen minutes, free, no treatment

The easiest way to judge whether a practice is unhurried is to sit in it for fifteen minutes. No treatment, no examination, no cost. Just the room, the person, and however many questions you have.

Book your free 15 minutes

4600 Crowchild Trail NW, Suite 505, Calgary · (587) 327-8651

Nothing is done to your teeth at this visit, and there is no cost.

This guide is general information about choosing dental care. It is not dental advice, it is not a diagnosis, and it is not a comment on any other practice. The questions in it are worth asking of any dentist, including this one. Your own dentist knows your mouth and your history, and nothing here replaces that. Reflections Dental Group, Calgary, Alberta.